

A lush, misty forest scene featuring large, dark tree trunks and a dense carpet of vibrant green ferns. The atmosphere is soft and ethereal, with light filtering through the canopy.

Colcom Foundation

Human activity is putting such a strain on the natural functions of Earth that the ability of the planet's ecosystems to sustain future generations can no longer be taken for granted. *Cordelia S. May*

A photograph of a rowing team on a river. The team consists of several rowers in a long, narrow boat, with their oars dipping into the water. The river is calm, reflecting the light. On the right bank, there are trees with yellow and orange autumn leaves. In the distance, another rowing team is visible on the water.

Cordelia S. May respected the beauty and balance of nature. She understood how this delicate balance had been compromised. By 1952, at age 23, charitable concerns for human quality of life led her to support family planning.

She recognized that incremental growth is imperceptible from one day to the next. The cumulative force of this growth would be overwhelming. Consequently, the impact of a burgeoning population on ecological balance would remain her lifelong passion.

Colcom Foundation was created by Cordelia S. May in 1996, at age 68, and was substantially funded following her death in 2005.

Today's headlines reflect the effects of imbalances between people and their surroundings. Water shortages, air pollution, groundwater contamination, beach closings, collapsed fisheries, competition over energy supplies, congestion, urban sprawl, biodiversity losses, and malnutrition are among the consequences of population growth. Yet, our growth-driven culture seldom views these imbalances as a result of overpopulation. Mrs. May's humanitarian perspective brought the approaching drama into focus decades before it reached public discourse.

Early reformers, like Mrs. May, were often misunderstood. George Bernard Shaw observed that "All great truths begin as blasphemies." Advocates of gender equity in the days of Susan B. Anthony, of civil rights in the age of Lincoln, and of modesty in the age of Galileo, were heretics. Their vindication would await the judgment of future historians.

Colcom Foundation's grantmaking honors the humanitarian objectives, the foresight, dignity, and compassion of its benefactor, Cordelia S. May.

Environment

Without love of the land, conservation lacks meaning or purpose. For only in a deep and inherent feeling for the land can there be dedication in preserving it. **Sigurd F. Olson**

Environment Regional

I thought of that (the theory of relativity)
while riding my bike. **Albert Einstein**

Environment Regional

The health of our surroundings does not vaporize before our eyes in a swift and thunderous event — the loss simmers over time, as forests slip into disharmony slowly, incrementally.

If America’s environmental losses of the past 50 years were suddenly inflicted by a foreign power, we would call it an act of war. Yet, the steady destruction of our natural environment fails to instill a sense of vulnerability.

Will future historians reflect positively upon our brief stewardship? Will we establish a commitment to improve the environment for our successors? Colcom Foundation, through its grantmaking, aims to foster dignity, respect, and compassion for our surroundings by addressing both the short- and long-term issues that threaten a sustainable quality of life.

The nation behaves well if it treats the natural resources as assets which it must turn over to the next generation increased, and not impaired, in value. Theodore Roosevelt



Powdermill Nature Reserve
Bird Banding Program
Scientific collection of data essential for monitoring changes or trends in bird population numbers. Data collected is used for research, education, and preservation efforts.



Allegheny Land Trust
Sycamore Island
Acquisition and management of Sycamore Island—the last undeveloped island in Allegheny County, Pennsylvania.



Student Conservation Association
Community Programs for the Three Rivers Region
Engage youth in conservation service projects while supporting local environmental initiatives.



Western Pennsylvania Conservancy
Freshwater
Conservation Strategy
Water conservation efforts including watershed conservation plans, watershed restoration projects, bathymetry initiatives, water trail mapping, algae studies, and many others.



Pittsburgh Zoo and PPG Aquarium
International Conservation Center
Development of an International Conservation Center in Somerset County, Pennsylvania for breeding of threatened and endangered species and for conservation and education programs.



Friends of the Pittsburgh Urban Forest
Urban Forest Stewardship Initiative
Engage citizens to maintain, plant, and protect urban trees—maximizing the substantial environmental, social, and economic benefits trees provide.



Pennsylvania Environmental Council, Foundation for Pennsylvania Watersheds
Pennsylvania Watersheds
Watershed conservation, preservation, and restoration projects in southwestern Pennsylvania.



Great Allegheny Passage
“Closing the Gap in the GAP,” Allegheny Trail Alliance
Acquisition and construction on the Great Allegheny Passage—a 150-mile multipurpose rail-trail system from Cumberland, Maryland to Pittsburgh. In Cumberland, the Passage links with the C&O Canal Towpath to Washington, D.C.

Environment Balance

More people means more stress on the environment. More roads. More cars. More oil. And more pressure on the economy and on a healthcare system that isn't working. Before we can honestly address the problems facing us, we need to have a serious discussion about the numbers. So, let's start talking.

NumbersUSA, Talk About Numbers, Talk About Immigration

According to figures released by the [Pew Research Center](#), **The approximate number of people expected to be added to the U.S. between 2005 and 2050 will equal the total number of people in Canada and Mexico.**

Environment Balance

Humanity’s balancing act with nature has been disrupted, but when will we summon the collective will to acknowledge the cause?

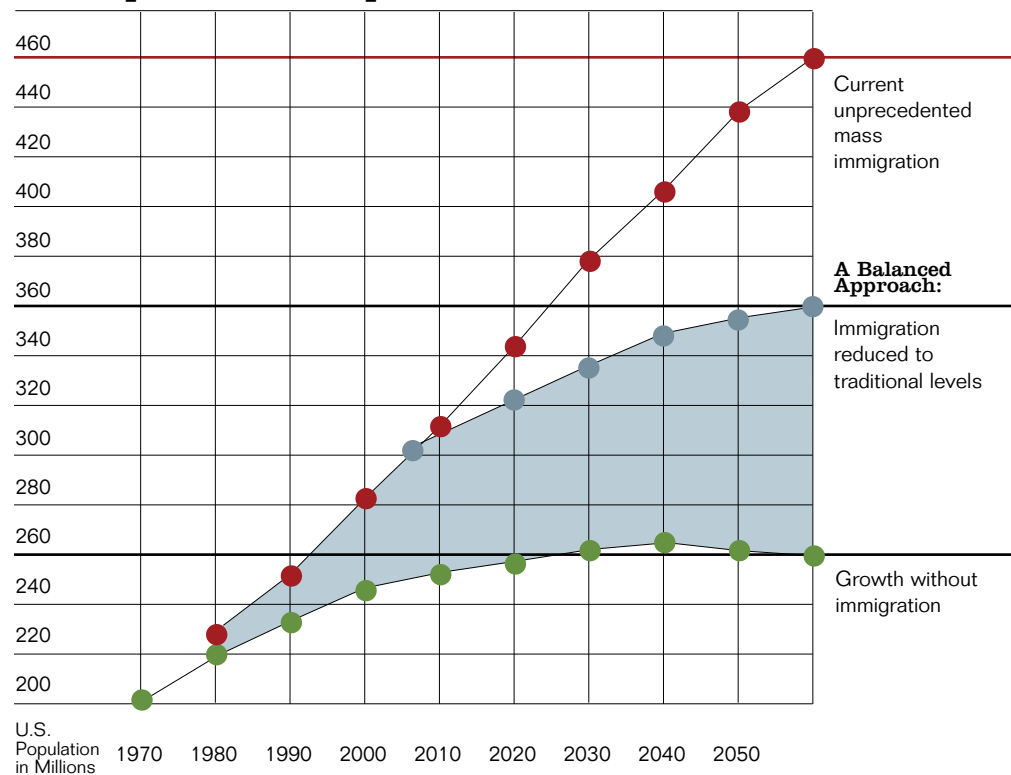
With every passing day, humanity adds more than 227,000 people to the face of the earth. That’s like adding another Pittsburgh every day and a half. Nature yields, but not painlessly. Our encroachment on the biological world can be masked for a while, but not indefinitely.

Sustainability depends on global, national, and local action. History no longer allows the United States to postpone addressing its overpopulation issue. Colcom Foundation hopes the nation will lead the world by attaining a sustainable balance with nature. Every person has a role in adopting conservation strategies, and the nation has a role in attaining sustainable numbers by encouraging responsible family planning and adopting respectable immigration policies.

As no political generation in history, ours may turn out to be the one that squandered the nation’s past, paralyzed its future, and never noticed either.

Senator Daniel Patrick Moynihan

U.S. Population Size Options



Salmon Crash Forces Drastic Measures
USA Today

Mercury Found in all Fish Caught in U.S.-tested Streams
USA Today

State of Emergency: Water Shortage Proclamation by the Governor of the State of California
USA Today



Battle Over Water Heats Up in Drought-Stricken California
USA Today

Southeast Drought Study Ties Water Shortage to Population, not Global Warming
The New York Times



Another Amphibian at Risk: Salamanders
The New York Times



Fish Study Raises Red Flag on Water Supply
Pittsburgh Post-Gazette



Pollution Prompts Record Beach Closings
WebMD Health News



Record Increase in U.S. Greenhouse Gas Emissions Reported
ENS



Pollution Linked to Lower IQ
Pittsburgh Tribune Review



Bird Species Plummet as Habitat Dwindles
San Francisco Chronicle

Chemicals That Eased One Woe Worsen Another
The Washington Post

Can anyone explain how mass immigration will make the air cleaner, the water tables higher, the parks more pristine, the commute faster, wildlife safer, or energy more abundant? It takes people of rare vision, foresight, and courage to recognize how immigration policy is really at the crux of how future generations of Americans will live.

Dan Stein, President, Federation for American Immigration Reform



Community

There is a reason that human beings long for a sense of permanence. This longing is not limited to children, for it touches the profoundest aspects of our existence: that life is short, and fraught with uncertainty. We know not where we come from, still less where we are going, and to keep from going crazy while we are here, we want to feel that we truly belong to a specific part of the world.

James Howard Kunstler, Author, *Geography of Nowhere*

Community

A vibrant quality of life depends on the economic and cultural prosperity of the City of Pittsburgh at our core and its many distinct neighborhoods.

Colcom Foundation strives to strengthen Pittsburgh’s sense of place by preserving the cultural, civic, social, historic, and commercial heart of the city. Grants maintain and improve our community by supporting recreation, parks, museums, and other destinations in America’s “most livable city.” The Foundation is committed to preserving the hometown appeal of our city of innovation, and to encouraging a sense of civic responsibility.

A person can grow to his or her full capacity only in a mutually caring relationship with others. Fred Rogers



**Event Committee
Pittsburgh, Inc.**
Pittsburgh 250
Pittsburgh’s 250th anniversary celebration in 2008.



Pittsburgh Downtown Partnership
Pittsburgh to Paris Project
Enlivening Pittsburgh’s streetscape with people, dining, and activities in historic European style.

Family Communications, Inc.
Tribute to Children
(*Mister Rogers Statue*, below)
Statue by sculptor Robert Berks honoring the late Fred Rogers and his lifelong dedication to children.



Western Pennsylvania Conservancy
City of Flowers Project, Downtown Pittsburgh
Greening downtown Pittsburgh’s Golden Triangle with the placement of 400 planters with flowers and vegetation.



Phipps Conservatory and Botanical Gardens
Chihuly Acquisitions
The acquisition of the Chihuly chandelier in Phipps Conservatory’s Welcome Center rotunda and other pieces as an enduring tribute for the 250-year anniversary of the City of Pittsburgh in 2008 and for the region-wide historic recognition of “Pittsburgh Celebrates Glass.”



National Aviary of Pittsburgh
Conservation and Field Research
Program to study the impacts of human population and resource consumption on birds and the environment. Projects span a range of topics and perspectives, from classical ecological research, to applied conservation, to more traditional zoo-based reintroduction activities.



Pittsburgh Zoo and PPG Aquarium
Water’s Edge Exhibit
Unique exhibit combines habitats for polar bears, sea otters, and walrus with conservation education.



Colcom Foundation

The primary mission of the Colcom Foundation is to foster a sustainable environment to ensure quality of life for all Americans by addressing major causes and consequences of overpopulation and its adverse effects on natural resources. Regionally, the Foundation supports conservation, environmental projects, and cultural assets.

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CORDELIA S. MAY
1928-2005

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AND A SPECIAL THANK YOU
TO OUR GRANTEES FOR
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“Loss of freedom is an inevitable
consequence of unlimited population
growth in a limited space” is
perhaps one of the wisest sentences
Garrett Hardin ever wrote. **Cordelia S. May**

Colcom Foundation

Committed to a Sustainable Future

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